

MBA RESUME CHECKLIST



Header	Notes
☐ Includes appropriate contact information: Name, Address (optional), Email, and Phone Number	
Education Section	Notes
☐ Generally 10-20% of the content	
☐ Spells out degrees (e.g. - Master of Business Administration rather than MBA)	
☐ Includes graduation month and year (e.g. - May 2021)	
☐ For MBA, list Candidate for Graduation with Distinction or High Distinction if applicable, not equivalent GPA	Follow the Ross Guidelines for listing academic honors
☐ Includes emphasis (singular) or emphases (plural), concentration, certificate, involvement, and honors that are relevant to target companies; does not waste space on details such as formal names	Refer to the CDO Guide to the MBA Resume for further guidance
Experience Section	Notes
☐ Generally 60-70% of content	
☐ Experience listed in reverse chronological order and account for all years since receiving undergraduate degree	
☐ Bullets within each position listed in order of importance to target recruiters	
☐ All bullets are in Action-Context-Result (ACR) format: • active verbs representing transferable skills relevant to target recruiters • context that identifies the situation in which you took the action; avoid "by statements" that explain "how" and instead focus on information that shows you can utilize the skill in circumstances similar to those you would encounter with your prospective employer • result that shows tangible impact / accomplishment	Action Words
☐ Bullet points are no more than 3 lines	If you don't know the actual result and can't make a reasonable estimate, it's fine to list the target result (e.g. - targeting 20% increase in revenue)
☐ Bullets stand alone and are easy to understand when read quickly	
Additional Section	Notes
☐ ~3 one-line bullets to communicate personal interests and traits that differentiate you	The best additional are both interesting and convey a trait target recruiters will value

MBA RESUME CHECKLIST (CONT.)



Overall

Notes

- ☐ Pay attention to detail:
 - NO typos
 - No unnecessary commas or spaces
 - Be consistent with punctuation and whether or not you spell out numbers
- ☐ Fills full page
- ☐ No orphan words taking up a whole line on resume
- ☐ No personal pronouns (e.g., "I," "my," "our," etc.)
- ☐ Avoids articles ("a," "an," and "the")
- ☐ Avoid using company name in bullets about that company
- ☐ No "filler" words (e.g., "successfully," "creatively," and most other "-ly" words - Demonstrate that you were successful, creative, etc., don't just claim it)

A misspelled word or typo is the quickest way to be eliminated from consideration for a position; employers expect attention to detail